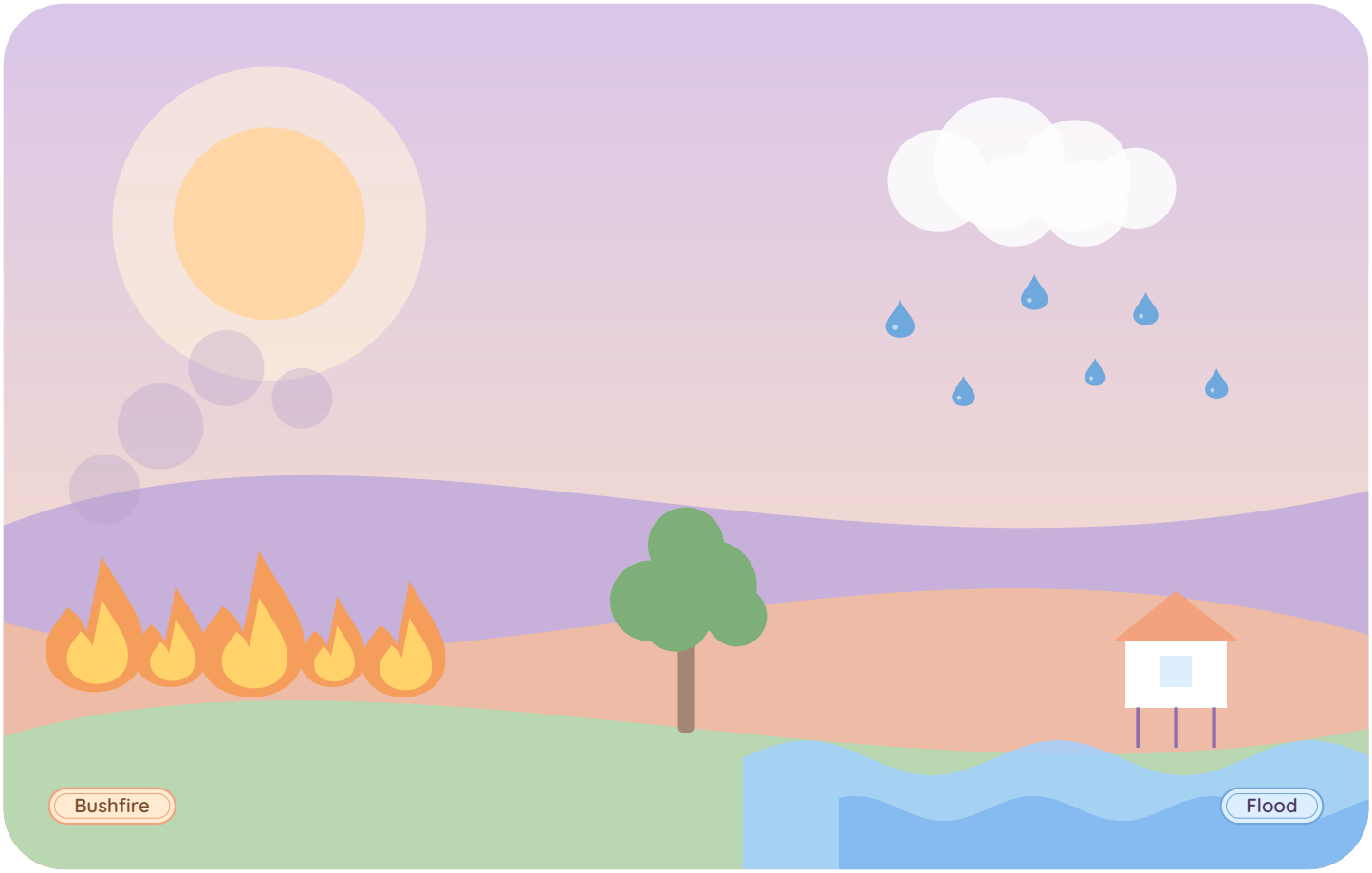


BUSHFIRES, FLOODS & EXTREME WEATHER IN AUSTRALIA

Effects & Management Workbook

Year 5–6 · HASS + Science · Australian Curriculum · Victorian Curriculum 2.0

Understand it. Prepare for it. Help your community recover from it.

INSIDE THIS WORKBOOK

- 2 Australian case studies: Black Summer and the 2022 floods
- First Nations cultural burning
- Effects tables in 3 levels: Support, At Standard, Extension
- My Family Emergency Plan
- Design a Resilient House
- Safety Poster Planning page
- Vocabulary with student-friendly definitions
- Answer Key, teaching support and marking rubric

Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

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Teacher Notes

Year 5–6 · Teacher Information

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CURRICULUM CODES

AC9HS5K05	Australian Curriculum v9.0	Humanities and Social Sciences (HASS), Year 5
ACSSU096	Australian Curriculum	Science Understanding, Year 6
VC2S6U05	Victorian Curriculum 2.0	Science, Levels 5 and 6 — Understanding
VC2S6U06	Victorian Curriculum 2.0	Science, Levels 5 and 6 — Understanding

LEARNING INTENTIONS

- Explain what natural hazards and natural disasters are, using Australian examples.
- Describe the effects of bushfires and floods on people, the environment and the economy.
- Compare how communities prepare for, respond to and recover from natural disasters.
- Explain how First Nations cultural burning cares for Country and reduces fire risk.
- Plan how a family or community can stay safe in an emergency.

SUCCESS CRITERIA (STUDENT-FRIENDLY)

- [ ] I can name three natural disasters that affect Australia.
- [ ] I can sort effects into people, environment and economy.
- [ ] I can explain two ways to reduce risk before a disaster.
- [ ] I can describe cultural burning and why it matters.
- [ ] I can create a clear and accurate safety message.

HOW TO USE THIS PACK

- **Suggested time:** 5 to 6 lessons of 45 to 60 minutes. Pages can also be used on their own as stand-alone tasks.
- **Lesson 1:** Page 4, then one effects page (Page 5 Support, 6 At Standard or 7 Extension). **Lesson 2:** Page 8. **Lesson 3:** Pages 9–10.
- **Lesson 4:** Page 11 (cultural burning). **Lessons 5–6:** Pages 12–14 (plan, design, poster). Page 15 (vocabulary) is used throughout.
- **Printing:** student pages are 4–15. Pages 2, 3 and 16–18 are for teachers. Remove the Answer Key (Pages 16–17) before copying for students.

ASSESSMENT AND FEEDBACK

- **Student Review:** every student page ends with a short self-check. Ask students to circle how independently they worked.
- **Evidence:** use the Challenge questions (Pages 9–10), the design task (Page 13) and the poster plan (Page 14) as higher-order evidence.
- **Marking:** use the rubric on Page 18 (six criteria, scored out of 24) and record a next step for each student.

DIFFERENTIATION GUIDE

SUPPORT

Page 5 with word bank and sentence starters. Read the case studies in pairs. Allow oral answers for Page 11.

AT STANDARD

Page 6 and all other pages as written. Students use specific examples from the case studies.

EXTENSION

Page 7 (short-term and long-term effects, cause and effect), the Challenge questions on Pages 9–10 and the evaluation on Page 13.

SENSITIVITY NOTE

Some students may have lived through a bushfire, flood or evacuation. Preview the case studies, let students pass on personal questions (especially Page 12) and keep the focus on safety, community strength and recovery.

FIRST NATIONS PERSPECTIVES

Cultural burning is knowledge held by Traditional Owners. Acknowledge the Traditional Owners of your local area before beginning. Where possible, invite a local Aboriginal community member or use resources made by Traditional Owner groups.

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Year 5–6 · HASS & Science

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Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

2 **Teacher Notes** — Curriculum codes, learning intentions, how to use, differentiation — Teacher page

4 **What Are Natural Disasters?** — Hazards, disasters and Australian examples — Student page

5 **Effects of Natural Disasters** Support — People, environment and economy — Student page

6 **Effects of Natural Disasters** At Standard — People, environment and economy — Student page

7 **Effects of Natural Disasters** Extension — Short-term and long-term effects — Student page

8 **Management and Prevention Strategies** — Prepare, respond and recover — Student page

9 **Case Study 1: The Black Summer Bushfires** — Short reading and comprehension — Student page

10 **Case Study 2: Recent Australian Floods** — Short reading and comprehension — Student page

11 **Cultural Burning: Caring for Country with Fire** — First Nations knowledge and reflection — Student page

12 **My Family Emergency Plan** — Practical planning activity — Student page

13 **Design a Resilient House** — Design and explain: bushfire or flood — Student page

14 **Safety Poster Planning Page** — Plan a poster for your community — Student page

15 **Vocabulary** — Key terms with student-friendly definitions — Student page

16–17 **Teacher Copy: Answers and Teaching Support** — Answer Key, misconceptions, re-teach — Teacher page

18 **Marking Rubric** — Simple 4-level rubric out of 24 — Teacher page

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What Are Natural Disasters?

Year 5–6 · Natural Hazards

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Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	describe natural hazards and natural disasters and give Australian examples.
KEY IDEA	A **natural hazard** is a natural event that could cause harm. It becomes a **natural disaster** when it seriously harms people, property, animals or the environment. Australia has very changeable weather, so long dry periods are often followed by heavy rain.
WORKED MODEL	Event: heavy rain for several days. Hazard: rivers could rise. Disaster: rivers flood the town, people are stranded and homes are damaged.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ explain hazard and disaster
- ☐ name Australian examples
- ☐ decide which could affect my area

Australian Examples

	What happens	Australian example
Bushfire	Fire spreads quickly through bush, grass or forest, helped by heat, dry plants and wind.	Black Summer, 2019–20
Flood	Water covers land that is usually dry after heavy rain or overflowing rivers.	Lismore, NSW, 2022
Cyclone	A powerful, spinning storm with strong winds and heavy rain, mostly in northern Australia.	Cyclone Tracy, Darwin, 1974
Drought	A long period of very low rainfall that causes water shortages.	Millennium Drought, 1997–2009
Heatwave	Several days of unusually high temperatures.	Victoria and South Australia, 2009

DID YOU KNOW?
Many Australian plants, such as some eucalypts and banksias, are adapted to fire. Their seeds can sprout after a fire has passed.

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

1. In your own words, what is the difference between a natural hazard and a natural disaster?

2. Decide: is each one a hazard or a disaster? Write **H** or **D**.

a) A cyclone forms over the ocean, far from land ☐

b) A cyclone destroys homes in a coastal town ☐

c) Dry grass and hot, windy weather are forecast ☐

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

3. Which natural disaster is most likely to affect your local area? Explain why.

4. Why do you think Australia experiences so many different natural hazards?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can explain the difference between a natural hazard and a natural disaster.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Effects of Natural Disasters

Year 5–6 · Support Version

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Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	sort the effects of bushfires and floods into people, environment and economy.
KEY IDEA	Disasters affect three parts of a community. **People:** lives, health, homes, schools. **Environment:** land, water, plants, animals. **Economy:** jobs, businesses, farms, repair costs.
WORKED MODEL	Bushfire → homes destroyed (people) → bush and habitat burnt (environment) → farms and tourism lose income (economy).

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ use the word bank
- ☐ sort effects correctly
- ☐ complete a sentence about effects

A. SORT

Write each word from the word bank in the table. Each word is used once.

WORD BANK

homes destroyed · animals lose habitat · people injured · jobs lost · farms damaged · soil washed away · roads closed · schools closed · smoke pollution · rebuilding costs

	PEOPLE	ENVIRONMENT	ECONOMY
BUSHFIRE			
FLOOD			

B. COMPLETE THE SENTENCES

1. A bushfire affects people because

.....

.....

2. A flood harms the environment by

.....

.....

3. Both disasters hurt the economy because

.....

.....

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can sort effects into people, environment and economy.

Circle one: independently · with one reminder · with support

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Effects of Natural Disasters

Year 5–6 · At Standard

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Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	describe the effects of natural disasters on people, the environment and the economy.
KEY IDEA	Strong answers give **specific** effects, not just "it was bad". Use Australian examples where you can.
WORKED MODEL	Flood, environment: "Floodwater washes soil and rubbish into rivers, which pollutes the water and harms fish and plants."

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ give two effects in each box
- ☐ use specific examples
- ☐ explain which effect is hardest to recover from

A. COMPLETE THE TABLE — write at least two effects in each box

	PEOPLE	ENVIRONMENT	ECONOMY
BUSHFIRE			
FLOOD			
CYCLONE OR DROUGHT (choose one)			

B. REASON

1. Which effect do you think is hardest for a community to recover from? Explain your thinking.

.....

.....

.....

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can describe effects on people, the environment and the economy.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Effects of Natural Disasters

Year 5–6 · Extension

Aussie Primary Academy | Australian & Victorian Curriculum | Learn, Analyse and Practise

Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	analyse short-term and long-term effects and explain how one effect leads to another.
KEY IDEA	Effects change over time. **Short-term** effects happen in the first days and weeks. **Long-term** effects last months or years. One effect can cause another (a chain of cause and effect).
WORKED MODEL	Homes destroyed → families displaced → children miss school → learning falls behind.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ separate short-term and long-term effects
- ☐ build a cause-and-effect chain
- ☐ evaluate who is most affected

A. COMPLETE THE TABLE

	PEOPLE	ENVIRONMENT	ECONOMY
BUSHFIRE SHORT-TERM			
BUSHFIRE LONG-TERM			
FLOOD SHORT-TERM			
FLOOD LONG-TERM			

B. REASON AND EVALUATE

1. Choose one effect and build a chain of at least three linked effects.

[ ] → [ ] → [ ] → [ ]

2. Some effects can be positive over time, such as new plant growth after fire or stronger community connections. Describe one and explain why it happens.

.....

.....

3. Do natural disasters affect everyone in a community equally? Justify your answer.

.....

.....

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can analyse effects over time.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

Evidence from my work: _____

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Management and Prevention Strategies

Year 5–6 · Prepare, Respond, Recover

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Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	classify strategies as prepare, respond or recover and explain why each stage matters.
KEY IDEA	Communities cannot stop natural hazards, but they can reduce harm. Management has three stages: **Prepare** (before), **Respond** (during) and **Recover** (after).
WORKED MODEL	"Clearing gutters and dry leaves" happens before a bushfire to reduce fuel, so it is **P** (Prepare).

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ sort strategies into stages
- ☐ explain why preparing matters
- ☐ name emergency organisations

FAST FACTS

Fire Danger Ratings: Moderate → High → Extreme → Catastrophic.
Flood rule: If it's flooded, forget it. Never walk, swim or drive through floodwater.
Emergency: call 000. **Flood and storm help:** SES 132 500.

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY — write P (Prepare), R (Respond) or Rec (Recover)

1. Clearing gutters and dry leaves from around a house ____
2. Listening to warnings on the radio or the VicEmergency app ____
3. Evacuating when authorities say to leave ____
4. Volunteers cleaning mud from homes after a flood ____
5. Building levees and drainage channels ____
6. Replanting trees and bushland ____
7. Packing an emergency kit ____
8. The SES rescuing people from floodwater ____
9. Counselling and support for affected families ____
10. Planned hazard-reduction and cultural burns ____

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

11. Why is preparing important even if a disaster never happens?

12. Name two organisations that help in emergencies. What does each one do?

13. Which stage (prepare, respond or recover) do you think is most often forgotten? Why?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can explain how communities prepare, respond and recover.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

One thing I will do to prepare at home: _____

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Case Study 1: The Black Summer Bushfires

Year 5–6 · Bushfire Case Study

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Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	read a case study and explain the causes and effects of a major Australian bushfire season.
KEY IDEA	Natural disasters usually have more than one cause. Good readers find the **causes**, the **effects** and the **community response**.
WORKED MODEL	Cause: drought + heat + wind. Effect: huge areas burned. Response: volunteers, evacuations and donations.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ find causes in a text ☐ describe effects on people and the environment ☐ explain how communities responded

READ

The Black Summer, 2019–20

In 2019 and 2020, Australia had its worst bushfire season in living memory. Known as the **Black Summer**, the fires burned across New South Wales, Victoria, Queensland, South Australia, Western Australia and Tasmania. After a severe drought, the bush was extremely dry. Record-breaking heat and strong winds made the fires spread fast.

More than 24 million hectares burned, an area larger than the state of Victoria. Thirty-three people died and more than 3,000 homes were destroyed. Scientists estimated that nearly three billion animals, including koalas, kangaroos and reptiles, were killed or displaced.

Towns were forced to evacuate. In Mallacoota, Victoria, about 1,000 people sheltered on the beach under an orange sky until the navy ship HMAS Choules took them to safety. Smoke covered cities hundreds of kilometres away, including Sydney and Canberra.

Firefighters, many of them volunteers, worked for months. Communities, schools and people overseas donated money, food and supplies. In the months that followed, green shoots began to appear on burnt trees as the bush started to recover.

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

1. What conditions made the fires so severe? Name two.

2. About how many hectares were burned?

3. What happened to people in Mallacoota?

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

4. Describe one effect of the fires on the environment and one effect on people.

5. How do we know that the bush can recover after a fire?

C. REASON AND EVALUATE — CHALLENGE

6. Why do you think so many people outside the fire zones helped? What does this show about communities?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can explain causes, effects and responses in a bushfire case study.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Case Study 2: Recent Australian Floods

Year 5–6 · Flood Case Study

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Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	read a case study and explain the causes, effects and recovery from a major Australian flood.
KEY IDEA	Floods cause damage quickly, but recovery can take months or years. Both **emergency services** and **ordinary people** play a part.
WORKED MODEL	Cause: days of heavy rain. Effect: homes and businesses flooded. Response: rescues. Recovery: clean-up and rebuilding.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ find key facts ☐ describe effects on people and the economy ☐ compare two disasters

READ

The 2022 East Coast Floods

In February and March 2022, days of extreme rain fell across Queensland and New South Wales. Rivers burst their banks. In Lismore, northern NSW, the Wilsons River rose to a record 14.4 metres, higher than any flood on record, and flooded homes, shops and schools.

More than 20 people died across the two states, and thousands of homes and businesses were damaged. Roads and bridges were cut off, power failed and many people were stranded on rooftops.

Emergency services including the State Emergency Service (SES) and the Australian Defence Force carried out rescues. Local people also helped. In Lismore, a group of locals who used their own small boats to rescue neighbours became known as the **Tinny Army**.

Recovery took many months. Families lived in temporary housing, volunteers helped to clean mud-filled homes, and some businesses did not reopen. In October 2022, floods also affected towns across Victoria, such as Rochester, Echuca and Maribyrnong. Australia's changing climate means extreme rain events may become more frequent.

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

1. Where did the 2022 floods happen? Name two states.

2. What was special about the height of the Lismore flood?

3. Who rescued people? Name at least two groups.

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

4. Describe one effect of the floods on people and one effect on the economy.

5. Why did recovery take so long?

C. REASON AND EVALUATE — CHALLENGE

6. Compare the Black Summer bushfires with the 2022 floods. Write one similarity and one difference.

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can explain causes, effects and recovery in a flood case study.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Cultural Burning: Caring for Country with Fire

Year 5–6 · First Nations Perspectives

Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Acknowledgement: We acknowledge the Traditional Owners of the lands on which we live and learn. We pay our respects to Elders past and present.

LEARNING INTENTION	describe cultural burning and explain how First Nations knowledge helps manage fire.
KEY IDEA	For tens of thousands of years, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples have used fire to care for Country. This is called **cultural burning**. It is knowledge passed down by Elders through stories, observation and practice.
WORKED MODEL	Traditional Owners read Country (weather, plants, soil, animals) → choose the right time and place → light a small, cool fire → clear dry undergrowth → plants regrow and animals return.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ describe cultural burning ☐ compare it with a large bushfire ☐ explain why listening to Traditional Owners matters

READ **Caring for Country**

Cultural burns are small, slow, cool fires, lit at the right time of year and in the right place. Traditional Owners read the signs of Country, such as the weather, plants, soil and animal behaviour, to decide when and where to burn. These fires clear dry undergrowth that could fuel a bigger fire, encourage new plant growth, support animals and food plants, protect important places and strengthen culture and connection to Country.

Hazard-reduction burns are run mainly to reduce fuel near towns. **Cultural burns** are led by Traditional Owners and are about caring for Country as a whole. Since the Black Summer fires, many fire agencies and Traditional Owner groups across Australia, including in Victoria, have worked together more closely to bring cultural burning back to the landscape.

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

1. In your own words, what is cultural burning?

2. How does a cultural burn differ from a large bushfire? Give two differences.

B. REFLECT

3. Why is it important to listen to Traditional Owners when managing Country?

4. What is one thing you learned that surprised you or changed your thinking?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can explain cultural burning respectfully.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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My Family Emergency Plan

Year 5–6 · Practical Activity

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Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	plan how a family can prepare for and respond to an emergency.
KEY IDEA	A plan made **before** an emergency helps people stay calm and act quickly. Practise it with your family. You can leave out personal details if you prefer.
WORKED MODEL	Risk: flood → meeting place: library on higher ground → contact: Aunty Sam out of town → kit: torch, radio, water, medicines.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ identify local risks
- ☐ list contacts and a meeting place
- ☐ build an emergency kit list

A. KNOW YOUR RISKS

1. Circle the hazards that could affect your area:

bushfire · flood · storm · heatwave · cyclone

B. CONTACTS AND MEETING PLACES

Emergency (police, fire, ambulance)	000
SES (flood and storm help)	132 500
Family contact 1	_____
Family contact 2	_____
Out-of-town contact	_____

Meeting place near home

_____

Meeting place outside our suburb or town

_____

C. OUR EMERGENCY KIT — tick what you have and write what you still need

- ☐ Torch and batteries
- ☐ Portable radio
- ☐ First aid kit
- ☐ Water (3 L per person per day)
- ☐ Medicines
- ☐ Phone charger or power bank
- ☐ Copies of important documents
- ☐ Pet supplies

Still need to get: _____

D. OUR PLAN

1. Where will we go if we need to leave?

2. How will we get there?

3. Who will look after our pets?

4. Where will we get warnings from? (radio, VicEmergency app, council)

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can plan for an emergency.

Circle one: independently · with one reminder · with support

The most important part of our plan is _____

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Design a Resilient House

Year 5–6 · Design and Explain

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Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	design a house that reduces damage from a bushfire or flood and explain how each feature helps.
KEY IDEA	Resilient design **reduces** damage but cannot remove all risk. Good designers think about materials, shape, position and cost.
WORKED MODEL	Feature: metal roof. It protects the house by not burning when embers land on it. Trade-off: it can cost more.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

☐ draw and label five features ☐ explain how each feature protects the house ☐ describe a trade-off

Choose one: BUSHFIRE-RESILIENT | FLOOD-RESILIENT

BUSHFIRE IDEAS

metal roof · fire-resistant materials · enclosed eaves · cleared space around the house · water tank · ember-proof screens

FLOOD IDEAS

raised floor or stilts · waterproof materials · high power points · sloped yard for drainage · flood barriers

A. DESIGN — draw your house and label at least five features

Draw here

B. EXPLAIN YOUR DESIGN

FEATURE	HOW DOES IT PROTECT THE HOUSE?
1.	
2.	
3.	

C. REASON AND EVALUATE

4. Which feature is the most important, and why?

5. Extension: What is one disadvantage of your design (for example cost or appearance), and how could you solve it?

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can design and explain a resilient house.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

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Safety Poster Planning Page

Year 5–6 · HASS and English Link

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Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	plan a poster that gives accurate safety information to a chosen audience.
KEY IDEA	A strong safety poster has **one clear message**, short text, accurate tips and an image that adds meaning.
WORKED MODEL	Audience: families. Message: leave early for bushfires. Slogan: “Go early, go safe.” Image: a car with a packed kit.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ choose a clear audience and message
- ☐ write three accurate tips
- ☐ plan images and colours with a purpose

Choose one: BUSHFIRE FLOOD

A. PLAN YOUR POSTER

TARGET AUDIENCE Who is the poster for?	
KEY MESSAGE One clear sentence	
THREE SAFETY TIPS Short and accurate	1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____
SLOGAN Short and memorable	
IMAGES OR SYMBOLS What will you draw?	
COLOURS AND WHY Choose with purpose	

B. SKETCH YOUR LAYOUT — mark where the title, images and tips will go

C. POSTER CHECKLIST

- ☐ Message is clear and accurate
- ☐ Large, readable title
- ☐ Includes 000 or relevant emergency information
- ☐ Images support the message
- ☐ Spelling and punctuation checked

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can plan a safety poster.

Circle one: independently with one reminder with support

One improvement I made: _____

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Vocabulary

Year 5–6 · Key Terms

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Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	use key terms accurately when writing about natural disasters.
KEY IDEA	Using the **right word** makes your writing clear and precise. Read each definition, then use the word in your own sentence.
WORKED MODEL	Evacuate: "The family had to **evacuate** when the fire danger rating reached Catastrophic."

SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN

- ☐ read each definition
- ☐ use a term in a sentence
- ☐ match a word to its meaning

Natural hazard
A natural event that could cause harm to people or places.

Natural disaster
A natural hazard that causes serious damage and suffering.

Bushfire
A fire that burns in bush, forest or grassland.

Flood
When water covers land that is normally dry.

Cyclone
A strong, spinning storm with heavy rain and powerful winds.

Drought
A long period with very little rain.

Evacuate
To leave a dangerous place and go somewhere safe.

Resilience
The ability to cope with difficulty and recover.

Emergency services
Groups such as fire, police, ambulance and the SES who help in emergencies.

Recovery
Rebuilding and healing after a disaster.

Cultural burning
Fire used by Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples to care for Country.

Hazard reduction
Planned burning or clearing to reduce the fuel for fires.

Economy
The money, jobs and businesses of a community.

Levee
A raised bank built to hold back floodwater.

Climate
The usual weather in a place over many years.

A. APPLY

1. Choose five words and use each one in a sentence of your own.

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2. Match. Write the word that fits each meaning: **evacuate · levee · resilience · drought**

a) a long time without rain _____

b) to leave for safety _____

c) a bank that holds back floodwater _____

d) recovering after hardship _____

STUDENT REVIEW ☐ I can use disaster vocabulary accurately.

Circle one: independently · with one reminder · with support

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Teacher Copy — Answers and Teaching Support

Year 5–6 · Teacher Copy

Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Accept equivalent responses when the student applies the targeted skill accurately and justifies the choice. Not for student use.

COMPLETE ANSWER KEY

Page 4 — What Are Natural Disasters?

1. A hazard is a natural event that could cause harm. A disaster is when it actually causes serious damage. 2. a) H b) D c) H

3–4. Answers vary. Accept reasoned local answers (for example bushfire for bushland areas, flood near rivers). Australia's large size, variable climate and mix of dry periods and heavy rain explain many different hazards.

Page 5 — Effects: Support (sample placements; accept logical alternatives, each word used once)

Bushfire: people: homes destroyed, people injured; environment: animals lose habitat, smoke pollution; economy: rebuilding costs, jobs lost. **Flood:** people: schools closed, roads closed; environment: soil washed away; economy: farms damaged.

Sentences: 1. homes are destroyed or people are injured. 2. washing soil and rubbish into rivers. 3. rebuilding is expensive and businesses close.

Page 6 — Effects: At Standard (samples)

Bushfire: people: deaths, homes lost, evacuation; environment: habitat loss, smoke, damaged forests; economy: rebuilding costs, tourism and farming losses. **Flood:** people: stranded, homes damaged, stress; environment: erosion, polluted waterways; economy: closed businesses, damaged crops, repair costs.

Cyclone or drought: accept accurate effects in each column. Q1: accept a reasoned choice (for example loss of homes, or mental health recovery).

Page 7 — Effects: Extension (samples)

Bushfire short-term: evacuations, power loss / loss of vegetation and animals / businesses close. **Bushfire long-term:** stress and rebuilding / slow bush regrowth / insurance costs and tourism losses.

Flood short-term: rescues and stranded people / sewage and debris in waterways / shops close. **Flood long-term:** housing shortages / soil and habitat damage / higher insurance and repair costs.

Chain: accept three or more logically linked effects. Positive effects: new growth after fire (seeds germinate, nutrients return) or stronger community connection. Q3: no — people with less money, health or support can be affected more.

Page 8 — Management and Prevention Strategies

1 P · 2 R · 3 R · 4 Rec · 5 P · 6 Rec · 7 P · 8 R · 9 Rec · 10 P

11. Preparing reduces harm and makes the response quicker. 12. For example SES: flood and storm rescue; fire services: fight fires and give warnings. Accept others. 13. Accept reasoned answers (often recovery).

Page 9 — Case Study 1: The Black Summer Bushfires

1. Drought, record heat, strong winds (any two). 2. More than 24 million hectares. 3. About 1,000 people sheltered on the beach and were taken to safety by HMAS Choules.

4. Environment: habitat loss, nearly three billion animals killed or displaced. People: 33 deaths, more than 3,000 homes destroyed, smoke. 5. Green shoots appeared on burnt trees. 6. Accept answers about empathy, shared responsibility and community support.

Page 10 — Case Study 2: Recent Australian Floods

1. Queensland and New South Wales. 2. The river rose to a record 14.4 m, higher than any flood on record. 3. SES, Australian Defence Force, local volunteers (the Tinny Army).

4. People: deaths, homes damaged, people stranded. Economy: businesses damaged or closed, repair costs. 5. Mud-filled homes, damaged roads and housing shortages took many months to fix. 6. Similarity: both damaged homes and needed community help. Difference: for example fire burns land while floodwater covers it. Accept other accurate answers.

Page 11 — Cultural Burning

1. Small, cool, planned fires used by Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples to care for Country. 2. Cultural burns are small, slow, cool, planned and led by Traditional Owners; large bushfires are hot, fast and uncontrolled.

3. Traditional Owners hold knowledge built over tens of thousands of years of caring for Country. 4. Personal response; accept respectful, specific answers.

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Teacher Copy — Answers (continued)

Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

COMPLETE ANSWER KEY (CONTINUED)

Pages 12–15 — Application pages

Page 12: personal response. Check that contacts, a meeting place and at least three kit items are listed. **Page 13:** accept features that match the chosen hazard with a logical explanation of how they protect; look for a trade-off such as cost.

Page 14: accept any accurate, audience-appropriate message. Check that 000 or other emergency information is included. **Page 15:** matching: a) drought b) evacuate c) levee d) resilience.

TEACHER CHECK AND NEXT STEP

- ☐ Identifies the target feature accurately and gives evidence.
- ☐ Applies the feature independently and explains its effect.

Next step: model one difficult item, complete one together, then repeat independently in a new context.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS / WATCH OUT

- A hazard is not the same as a disaster. The harm done is what makes it a disaster.
- Fire is not always harmful in Australia. Cultural burning and plants' fire adaptations show fire has a role in healthy landscapes.
- Disasters do not affect everyone equally. Consider who has the most support.
- Cultural burning is not just hazard reduction. Avoid describing it only as a fire-control tool.
- Floods are not only caused by rain at the location. Rivers can rise from rain far upstream.

EXTENSION AND RE-TEACH

Re-teach: model one item aloud, complete one together, then ask the student to explain an independent correction.

Extension: write a short persuasive letter to a local council recommending one flood or bushfire preparation measure, using two facts from the case studies as evidence.

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Marking Rubric

Year 5–6 · Teacher Use

Aussie Primary Academy | Australian & Victorian Curriculum | Learn, Analyse and Practise

Australian Curriculum: AC9HS5K05 · ACSSU096 | **Victorian Curriculum 2.0:** VC2S6U05 · VC2S6U06

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

SIMPLE 4-LEVEL RUBRIC — circle the level that best matches the student's work

CRITERION	4 · EXTENDING	3 · AT STANDARD	2 · DEVELOPING	1 · BEGINNING
Understanding of disasters	Explains hazards and disasters accurately, with detailed Australian examples. ○	Explains accurately, with some examples. ○	Partly accurate; few examples. ○	Little accurate understanding. ○
Effects: people, environment, economy	Analyses short- and long-term effects and the links between them. ○	Describes specific effects in all three areas. ○	Gives general effects in some areas. ○	Gives few or unclear effects. ○
Management and prevention	Evaluates strategies and explains how they reduce harm. ○	Explains prepare, respond and recover with examples. ○	Names strategies with limited explanation. ○	Names one strategy. ○
First Nations perspectives	Explains cultural burning respectfully and connects it to caring for Country. ○	Describes cultural burning accurately. ○	Partly describes cultural burning. ○	Little understanding. ○
Application: plan, design, poster	Creative, accurate, detailed and well justified. ○	Clear, accurate and complete. ○	Partly complete or partly accurate. ○	Incomplete. ○
Vocabulary and communication	Uses key terms precisely in clear writing. ○	Uses key terms correctly. ○	Uses some key terms. ○	Rarely uses key terms. ○

SCORE ____ / 24

20–24 Extending · 15–19 At Standard · 10–14 Developing · 6–9 Beginning

Teacher comment: _____

_____

Student next step: _____

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